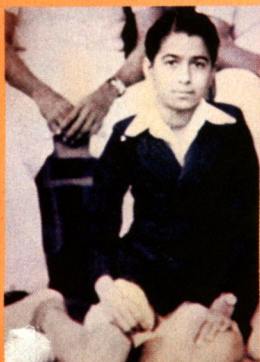


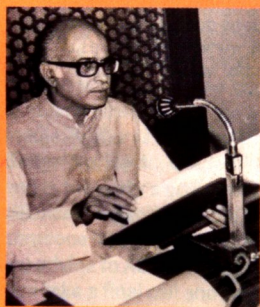
Long and Winding Road

The toughest test in Advani's political career seems



1927 Born November 8 in Karachi, Advani went to the local Catholic-run St. Patrick's High School and graduated from the National College in Hyderabad, Sindh. After Partition, the family moved to Mumbai where he did his Bachelor's in Law. Married Kamla in 1965. They have two children, son Jayant and daughter Pratibha.

1951 Joined Jan Sangh. Was elected chairman of the Delhi Metropolitan Council, the equivalent of today's chief minister, in 1967. Was president of Jan Sangh from 1973 to 1977.

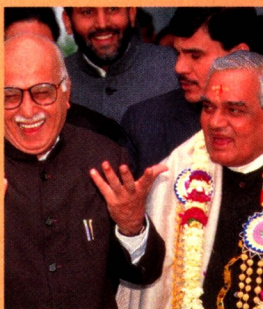


Later in 1977, he became the Union minister for information and broadcasting in the first non-Congress government at the Centre. In 1980, became Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha and was founder general secretary of the BJP from 1980 to 1986. Was president of BJP for three terms between 1986 and 2005. It was largely due to his efforts that the BJP, which won just two seats in the 1984 Lok Sabha elections, saw its tally rise phenomenally to 88 in 1989.

1990 Defining Moment came on September 25 when Advani set off on the first of his many rath yatras

that changed forever the contours of Indian politics.

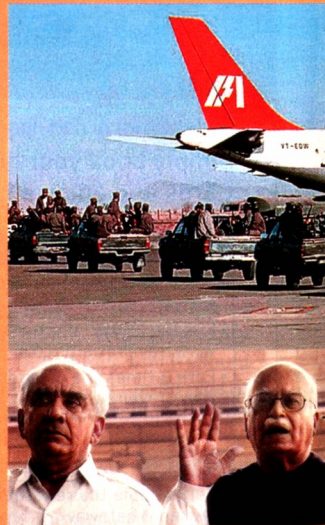
1998 Took Charge as Union home minister in



short-lived A.B. Vajpayee government of 1998-99 and again from 1999 to 2004. In 2002, he was elevated to deputy prime minister, a resounding vote of trust from the prime minister for his

most loyal colleague and an effort to infuse dynamism into the functioning of the government. While Vajpayee remained the chairman emeritus of the NDA Board, Advani was the CEO.

1999 The Low Point in Advani's tenure as home minister came on Christmas Eve 1999 when hijackers took over Indian Airlines Flight IC-814 from Kathmandu to Delhi. The government was seen to be



SIPRA DAS

too slow to respond to the hijacking and the drama went on for a full week. After external affairs minister Jaswant Singh accompanied three terrorists to Kandahar and personally handed them over to the hijackers, Advani claimed

